

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Eighteenth-century frame: crisis and reordering

MUGHAL CENTRE CONTRACTS -> provincial, confederate and local arenas gain leverage

CORE QUESTION -> how revenue, armed labour, credit and legitimacy form regional states

TWO ERRORS -> pure chaos / universal prosperity

VERDICT -> uneven state formation, commercial continuity and social cost coexist.

MUST REMEMBER: Hyderabad, Awadh and Bengal adapted Mughal offices, while Maratha, Sikh, Jat, Mysore and other formations followed distinct fiscal-military and regional routes.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Three state types, not one hierarchy

SUCCESSOR -> Bengal, Awadh, Hyderabad: Mughal office becomes practical autonomy

AUTONOMOUS / REGIONAL -> Mysore, Travancore, Rajput houses: older fields centralise selectively

NEW / MOBILISED -> Marathas, Sikhs, Jats, Rohillas: armed networks and local solidarities

RULE -> origin category does not predetermine capacity or welfare.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Regional chronology and bounded sequence

1707-20 -> succession, Shahu-Tarabai conflict and Banda Bahadur

1720s-40s -> Hyderabad, Awadh, Bengal consolidate; Baji Rao expands

1740s-61 -> Alivardi, Maratha northern bid, Sikh recovery and Afghan pressure

POST-1761 -> later Mysore, Ranjit Singh and Company only as bounded trajectory.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Hyderabad, Awadh and Bengal compared

HYDERABAD -> Nizam-ul-Mulk turns subedari and military authority into autonomy

AWADH -> Saadat Khan / Safdar Jang work through chiefs, taluqdars and imperial office

BENGAL -> Murshid Quli Khan and successors concentrate revenue and banking links

SHARED -> Mughal forms survive | DIFFERENCE -> alliance, finance and local control vary.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Maratha confederacy: reach and coordination

SATARA / POONA -> chhatrapati, Peshwa and negotiated leadership

CHAUTH + SARDESHMUKHI -> fiscal claims interact with local collection

SCINDIA / HOLKAR / GAEKWAD / BHONSLE -> expanding houses and regional bases

TRAP -> neither a unitary nation-state nor only raiding; coordination had limits.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Sikhs: community, mobilisation and misls

KHALSA LEGACY -> persecution, mobilisation and armed community formation

BANDA BAHADUR -> early challenge; later repression changes the field

DAL KHALSA / MISLS -> fluid armed-territorial networks in Punjab

BOUNDARY -> Ranjit Singh belongs only as a later consolidating bridge.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Mysore, Rajputs and Jats: bounded comparisons

MYSORE -> Haider Ali / Tipu: military and administrative centralisation, later bounded

RAJPUT STATES -> court, tribute, diplomacy and selective autonomy

JATS -> agrarian-zamindari mobilisation around Bharatpur and Suraj Mal

RULE -> compare resource route and legitimacy; avoid a single 'rebel state' label.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: State-formation engine

REVENUE ASSESSMENT + INTERMEDIARIES -> treasury and credit

CREDIT / BANKERS -> advances, remittance and military payment

ARMY -> enforces revenue and rewards clients -> court and patronage become durable

LIMIT -> warfare and extraction can strengthen rulers while burdening cultivators.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Society: hierarchy with differentiated agency

CASTE / CLASS / REGION -> condition access to land, work, honour and mobility

WOMEN -> elite sources show particular agency; ordinary labour needs cautious reconstruction

PEASANTS -> production base facing varied rents, dues, credit and war disruption

SOLDIERS / OFFICIALS -> selective mobility without dissolving hierarchy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Commercialisation links town and countryside

PEASANT SURPLUS -> markets, revenue and military supply

ARTISANS -> textiles, arms and specialised work | MERCHANTS -> brokerage and trade

BANKERS / HUNDIS -> credit and long-distance remittance

QUALIFY -> commercial dynamism does not prove equal prosperity or secure cultivation.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Political plurality and warfare coexisted with credit, textile production, urban patronage and unequal social burdens; neither 'anarchy' nor universal prosperity fits all regions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Culture and institutional continuity

PERSIANATE COURTS + regional languages -> administrative and literary continuity

COURTS / TOWNS -> art, architecture, music and patronage shift regionally

MUGHAL SYMBOLS -> titles, coin, khutba and records remain politically usable

VERDICT -> cultural production persists amid war, hierarchy and changing patrons.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Use revenue records, banking networks, courtly evidence and regional scholarship to qualify both colonial chaos narratives and over-corrective continuity claims.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 02 answer spine

CLASSIFY -> successor / autonomous-regional / newly mobilised states

COMPARE -> Hyderabad, Awadh, Bengal, Marathas, Sikhs, Mysore, Rajputs and Jats

EXPLAIN -> administration, revenue, army, credit and local alliances

INTEGRATE -> caste, gender, peasants, artisans and commercial networks

CLOSE -> neither chaos nor prosperity was universal; give a region-and-group verdict.